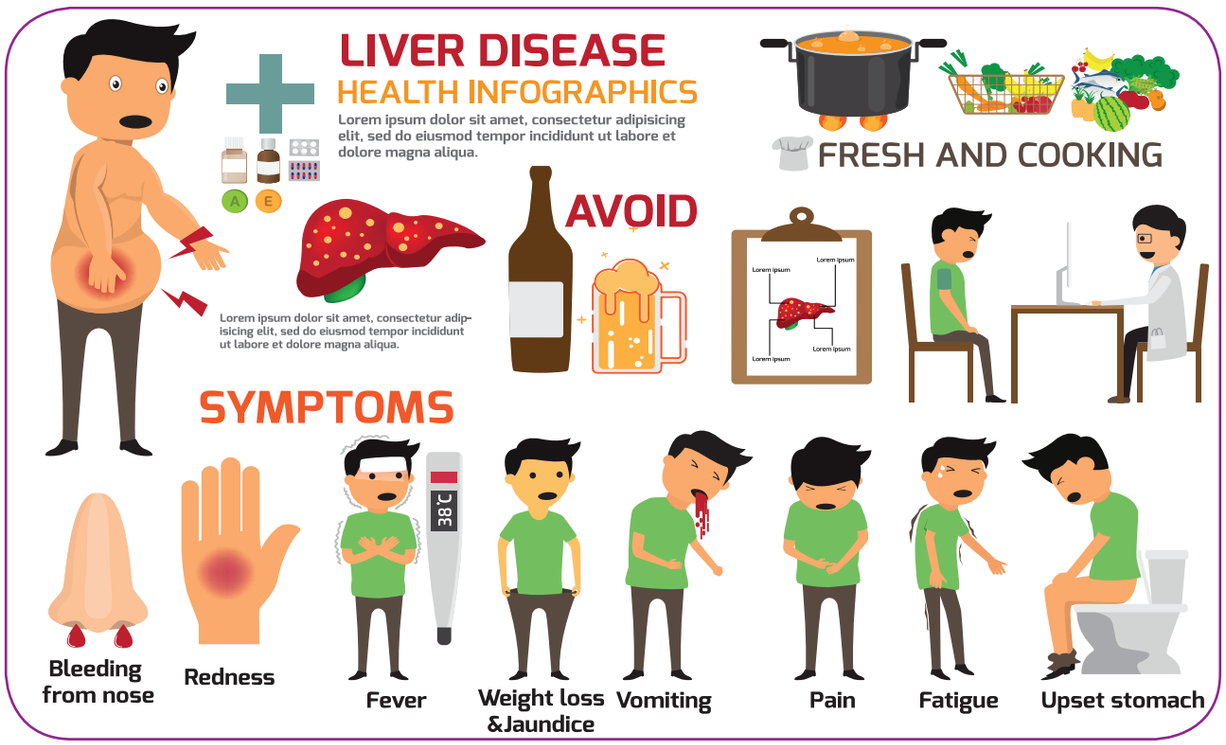


a) Acute Viral Hepatitis

Acute viral hepatitis is a sudden onset of inflammation in liver. It is caused by hepatitis viruses A, B, C, D and E. Hepatitis A and E are infectious which is spread by fecal oral route. Hepatitis B, C and D are transmitted through blood and body fluids.

The general symptoms of viral hepatitis are:

- Fever
- Arthalgia
- Arthritis
- Rash
- Malaise
- Fatigue
- Myalgia
- Anorexia
- Nausea
- Vomiting
- Jaundice (Icterus)

Chronic Hepatitis

When hepatitis is prolonged for more than six months, it is called as chronic hepatitis. Chronic hepatitis is serious and may lead to serious damage to the liver. The causes for chronic hepatitis can be autoimmune, viral, metabolic disorders and drugs or toxin. Clinical symptoms of chronic hepatitis are non-specific and are mild.

Common symptoms include fatigue, sleep disorders, mild right upper quadrant pain, jaundice, muscle wasting, tea coloured urine, ascites, and hepatic encephalopathy.

Jaundice in Liver Diseases!

Jaundice is the yellow discolouration of the skin, mucous membranes and sclera. Jaundice occurs due to accumulation of bile pigments in the blood. If the liver is infected or diseased or the flow of bile is obstructed, then it gets accumulated in the blood resulting in jaundice.

Jaundice can be of three types:

- **Haemolytic Jaundice or Pre- hepatic Jaundice:** Increased unconjugated plasma bilirubin
- **Hepatic Jaundice:** Liver cells are damaged
- **Obstructive or Post – hepatic Jaundice:** Obstruction in the flow of bile into duodenum due to stones or cancer

UNIT-8_DIET IN GASTRO INTESTINAL AND LIVER DISORDERS.indd 134 25-02-2019 15:36:45